

BRAZILIAN BOOT CAMP!

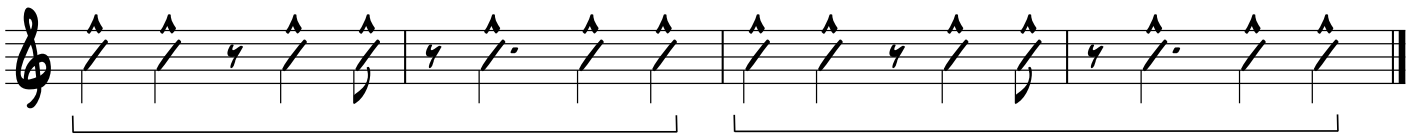
FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #162

Partido Alto is a rhythm from Brazil, and is a big part of many Samba styles. We see it in percussion parts, in melodic passages, and in comping rhythms in everything from snare drum to piano to guitar to horn backgrounds. In short, you sound pretty legit when you play this rhythm. So, let's get you sounding legit!

Like so many West African rhythms, or rhythms derived from West African roots, this rhythm is two measures long, and has a sort of "call and response" sound built right in to it. Since it comes from the percussion language, we generally hear it played (on all instruments) very marcato, or detached, or staccato, mimicing the percussive instruments that most typically play it.

Samba is felt in "two," so be tapping your foot (or have the metronome click) on beats 1 and 3, to get the feel we are looking for. Any tempo works, but tempos where the half note is between 80 - 100 (metronome setting of 160 - 200) is where this will sound most natural.

#1 - Partido Alto



#2 - Major Scale



#3 - Dominant b5/#11 Arpeggio

